

NF Photography — Brand Guidelines

A working reference for everything visual: the mark, the colour, the type, the tone.

Built for one photographer; designed to last as the work grows.

Version 1.0 **Date** May 2026 **Owner** Nicholas Falzon · Malta **Contact** nfalzon.com ·
@nfalzon_photos

Contents

1. The brand
2. Voice & values
3. The logo
4. Colour
5. Typography
6. Buttons
7. Voice & tone in writing
8. Quick reference

This document is a working reference. It will evolve as the brand does. When something written here stops being true of the work, update the document — don't keep the work consistent with an outdated rule.

1. The brand

Overview

NF Photography is the Malta-based sports photojournalism practice of Nicholas Falzon, working with clubs, athletes, federations, and sponsors. The business documents live sport — football, futsal, motorsport, waterpolo, and more — and delivers published-quality imagery that clubs and athletes can actually use to grow their reach, win sponsors, and build their profile.

Where most local sports photography is volunteer-grade or generic, NF Photography brings the discipline of photojournalism: serious work, filed on deadline, across the sports most Maltese photographers won't or can't cover.

Positioning statement

The working sports photojournalist Maltese clubs, athletes, and federations can actually book — covering football, futsal, motorsport, and waterpolo with published-quality imagery delivered on a journalist's timeline.

Two names, used on purpose

The brand operates under two coordinated names:

Name	Use case
NF Photography	Business name. Invoices, contracts, proposals, watermarks, sponsorship decks, website footer, social handles.
Nicholas Falzon	Personal name. About page, newspaper credits, athlete and club conversations, email signatures, press features.

Clubs and federations hire a *business* under contract; athletes and journalists trust a *person* on the sideline. Running both names in parallel lets the brand serve B2B credibility and B2C relationship-building at the same time.

Tagline

Primary tagline

■ **Pitchside, poolside, trackside.**

Three words signalling multi-sport range, naming the actual environments NF Photography works in. It's the hero line on the website, social bios, and proposal covers — and impossible for competitors to credibly copy unless they shoot all three.

Supporting line (longer-form copy)

■ *Sport, captured properly.*

Used in proposals, manifestos, and the back-end of an "about" page. Quietly confrontational — implies the alternative (most local sports photography) is improperly done, which is the brand's market opening.

Target market

- **Primary clients (B2B):** Maltese football and futsal clubs, waterpolo clubs and the national federation, motorsport teams and event promoters, sports federations needing season-long media coverage.
 - **Secondary clients:** Individual athletes building personal brands, sponsors needing match-day imagery, sports journalists and local press.
 - **Geography:** Malta + occasional regional travel.
 - **Positioning tier:** Mid-tier professional.
-

2. Voice & values

Core values

Four values, each defensible in a real client conversation. They pair naturally: **Craft** + **Speed** (the product), **Range** + **Trust** (the relationship).

01 • Craft

Newspaper-grade quality on every shoot. Lighting, composition, colour, and edit are intentional — never spray-and-pray. The benchmark is publishable, not "good enough for socials."

02 • Speed

Same-day social-ready edits. Full galleries within 48 hours. In sport, late media is dead media — turnaround is part of the product.

03 • Range

Football, futsal, motorsport, waterpolo, and beyond. Range is a service promise: multi-sport clubs and federations can hire one trusted photographer instead of three.

04 • Trust

Reliable delivery, clean licensing, professional conduct around athletes, parents, journalists, and sponsors. Boring on paper; decisive in winning repeat contracts.

Personality

■ **A sports photojournalist who takes the work seriously and knows how to get it done.**

NF Photography is not a creative-for-hire, a content creator, or a hobbyist with a camera. It is a working photojournalist running a business — a discipline with its own standards, posture, and history. The brand inherits all of that.

Dial	Setting
Confidence	Serious and quiet. The work, the press credits, and the track record speak. No self-promotion theatre.
Tone	Photojournalistic — observational, factual, sport-fluent. Reports the moment; doesn't dramatise it.
Posture	Professional. Shows up early, shoots through the full match, files on deadline. No excuses, no drama, no diva.
Spotlight	On the sport and the athlete. The photojournalist documents; he is never the story.
Aesthetic	Documentary-modern. Editorial-grade. Built for the back page of a paper, not for a wedding album.
Reliability	The defining trait. A photojournalist's reputation lives or dies on whether the file lands on time.

What the brand is not: a creative agency, a "visual storyteller," a content shop, a brand-experience studio, or a lifestyle photographer who also shoots sport. It is a sports photojournalist — and the brand voice should sound like one.

3. The logo

The mark

The logo is the existing **NF Photography monogram framed by four corner brackets** — a reference to the camera viewfinder and the editorial crop mark. The frame signals "photographer" without spelling it out.

- **Master file:** `nf-logo-with-frame-a-symmetric.png` (520 × 520 px)
- **Brackets-only overlay:** `nf-frame-brackets-overlay.svg` (drop onto your real vector logo file in Illustrator or Figma)

Variants

- **White-on-dark** (primary) — for use on photography, dark backgrounds, social tiles
- **Black-on-light** — for use on white surfaces, print, documents

Usage rules

Always

- Keep clear space around the logo equal to the height of the "N" on all sides
- Use white-on-dark on photography or dark backgrounds; black-on-light on white
- Output as vector wherever possible (PDF, SVG); use raster (PNG) only for screens

Never

- Don't recolour the logo in arbitrary brand colours — only black, white, or single-tone teal/navy from the palette
- Don't add drop shadows, glows, outlines, or effects
- Don't stretch, skew, or rotate
- Don't crowd it: respect the clear space rule

Minimum sizes

Application	Minimum width	Notes
Full lockup (with PHOTOGRAPHY wordmark)	80 px / 25 mm	Below this, wordmark becomes illegible
Icon-only (NF + brackets)	24 px / 8 mm	For favicons, watermarks, profile avatars
Print and large display	No upper limit	Always export from vector source

Watermark

Use the icon-only version (NF + brackets, no PHOTOGRAPHY wordmark) for image watermarks. Position bottom-right at 2–4% of image width. Subtle white at low opacity is the default; full-strength only when the licence requires high visibility.

4. Colour

Philosophy

Black is the foundation. **Teal is the brand accent** (energy, freshness). **Navy is the brand depth** (authority, editorial weight). Together they give the brand a layered voice that single-accent systems can't reach.

All colours below are WCAG AA-compliant for their stated use. Status colours (success, warning, error) are kept neutral and conventional — they're for UI feedback, not brand expression.

Brand colours

Foundation Black

- **Hex:**  #0A0A0A
- **Token:** neutral-950
- **Use:** The brand's anchor. Logo background, primary surfaces in inverted contexts, default action button. Reserved over pure  #000000 because it's slightly softer on screen.

Brand Teal

- **Hex:**  #14B8A6
- **Token:** teal-500
- **Use:** The brand accent. Hero displays, dark sections, decorative accents. Reads as energy and freshness.
- **On light backgrounds:** step to teal-700  #0F766E for text and teal-600  #0D9488 for fills (the brand teal itself fails AA contrast on white)

Brand Navy

- **Hex:**  #1E3A8A
- **Token:** navy-900
- **Use:** The brand depth. Editorial heading colour, feature section backgrounds, secondary identity expression. Reads as authority and considered weight.
- **In dark mode:** feature surfaces use navy-700  #1D4ED8 to stand out from the page.

Three usage patterns

The system supports three distinct visual moods. Most pages will mix them.

Pattern	Mood	Use for
1 • Default	Black on white with occasional teal accents	Portfolio galleries, services pages, blog posts, contact forms
2 • Editorial	Navy heading on white, neutral body, teal inline accent	About pages, manifesto sections, mission statements, editorial headlines
3 • Feature	Navy section with white text and light teal accent	Press blocks, sponsorship sections, hero callouts, season-stat moments

Key semantic tokens

These are the tokens you reference in components. The full palette ramps (50–950) for each colour family are defined as raw tokens in `nf-color-system.css`.

Token	Light	Dark	Use
<code>--color-bg</code>	 #FFFFFF	 #0A0A0A	Page background
<code>--color-text</code>	 #171717	 #FAFAFA	Body, default headings
<code>--color-text-muted</code>	 #404040	 #D4D4D4	Secondary copy
<code>--color-text-subtle</code>	 #737373	 #A3A3A3	Captions, metadata
<code>--color-text-accent</code>	 #0F766E	 #2DD4BF	Teal text — accent in copy
<code>--color-text-secondary</code>	 #1E3A8A	 #93C5FD	Navy text — editorial headings
<code>--color-fill-accent</code>	 #0D9488	 #14B8A6	Teal fills — buttons, badges, dots
<code>--color-bg-feature</code>	 #1E3A8A	 #1D4ED8	Navy section backgrounds
<code>--color-text-success</code>	 #15803D	 #4ADE80	Success status
<code>--color-text-warning</code>	 #B45309	 #FCD34D	Warning status
<code>--color-text-error</code>	 #DC2626	 #F87171	Error status

Status colour palette

Used only for UI feedback (form errors, success messages, alerts) — never for brand expression.

Status	Default fill	Light text	Dark text
Success	 #16A34A (green-600)	 #15803D	 #4ADE80
Warning	 #F59E0B (amber-500)	 #B45309	 #FCD34D
Error	 #EF4444 (rose-500)	 #DC2626	 #F87171

5. Typography

The pairing

Two fonts, both free on Google Fonts, both loaded as variable fonts (one file each, full weight range).

Role	Font	Weights	Used for
Headings	Space Grotesk	400–700	h1–h6, display, eyebrows
Body	Inter	400–700	body, lead, small, caption, buttons

Why this pairing: Space Grotesk is a contemporary geometric grotesk with subtle character — distinctive enough to give headlines presence, restrained enough to feel professional. Inter is the gold standard for screen body text — hugely legible, neutral but not sterile. Together: Space Grotesk gives the brand its voice in big moments; Inter does the heavy lifting of actual reading.

Loading:

```
html
```

```
<link rel="stylesheet" href="https://fonts.googleapis.com/css2?family=Space+Gro
```

Type scale

A **1.25 (minor third) modular scale**, anchored on 16px body. Tight enough to feel refined and editorial, wide enough to give clear hierarchy.

Token	rem	px	Use
<code>--text-display</code>	3.75rem	60px	Hero headings, poster moments
<code>--text-h1</code>	3rem	48px	Page heading
<code>--text-h2</code>	2.25rem	36px	Major section heading
<code>--text-h3</code>	1.875rem	30px	Section heading
<code>--text-h4</code>	1.5rem	24px	Sub-section heading
<code>--text-h5</code>	1.25rem	20px	Minor heading
<code>--text-h6</code>	1.125rem	18px	Smallest heading
<code>--text-lead</code>	1.125rem	18px	Lead paragraph, intro copy
<code>--text-body</code>	1rem	16px	Default body
<code>--text-small</code>	0.875rem	14px	Meta, secondary, footnotes
<code>--text-caption</code>	0.75rem	12px	Photo credits, fine print

On screens narrower than 640px, the largest sizes (`display`, `h1`, `h2`, `h3`) automatically shrink so headlines don't overflow on mobile.

Line heights & letter spacing

Underlying principle: as text gets bigger, tracking gets tighter and line height gets shorter.

Token	Value	Used on
<code>--leading-tight</code>	1.1	Display, h1, h2
<code>--leading-snug</code>	1.25	h3, h4, h5, h6
<code>--leading-normal</code>	1.5	Body, lead
<code>--leading-relaxed</code>	1.625	Long-form reading
<code>--tracking-tighter</code>	-0.025em	Display, h1
<code>--tracking-tight</code>	-0.015em	h2, h3
<code>--tracking-normal</code>	0	Default
<code>--tracking-wide</code>	0.075em	Eyebrow / overline

Heading weight rule

Default heading weight is **600 (semibold)**, not 700 (bold). Space Grotesk at 600 already carries plenty of presence — going bold makes it feel heavy-handed for a brand whose voice is meant to be quietly confident. Use 700 only for display/hero moments where extra impact is needed.

Eyebrow pattern

The single highest-leverage editorial layout move you can make:

PRESS · WATERPOLO ← eyebrow (caption size, uppercase, tracked, teal)

Behind the lane line. ← heading (h1 or h2)

A season covering... ← lead paragraph

Use this on every major page section — about, services, portfolio category headers, press features.

6. Buttons

Three variants, one geometry

Hierarchy is built on **contrast against the page**, not colour. Brand colours stay reserved for accents and brand moments, not for asking the user to click.

Variant	Default appearance	Use for
Primary	Black fill, white text	The single most important action on a section. Booking, submitting, confirming. One per section, never two.
Secondary	Transparent, neutral border	An alternative to a primary. "View portfolio" next to "Book a shoot."
Ghost	Transparent, no border	Cancels, skips, less important inline actions. Looks clickable without shouting.

States

State	Trigger	Visual change
Default	At rest	Variant's defined colours
Hover	Cursor over	Background shifts (primary darkens; secondary fills subtly; ghost fills subtly)
Active	Mouse down	Brief return toward default (primary) or deeper fill (secondary, ghost)
Focus	Keyboard tab	2px outline ring, 2px offset
Disabled	disabled attribute	40% opacity, cursor: not-allowed

Sizes

Size	Padding	Font size	Total height
.btn-sm	6px / 14px	12px	32px
(default)	10px / 20px	14px	40px
.btn-lg	14px / 28px	16px	48px

HTML usage

html

```

<!-- Primary CTA -->
<button class="btn btn-primary">Book a shoot</button>

<!-- Secondary, paired next to a primary -->
<button class="btn btn-primary">Book this package</button>
<button class="btn btn-secondary">See sample gallery</button>

<!-- Ghost, for low-emphasis tertiary actions -->
<button class="btn btn-ghost">Cancel</button>

<!-- Sizes and modifiers -->
<button class="btn btn-primary btn-sm">Small</button>
<button class="btn btn-primary btn-block">Full width</button>

<!-- Disabled -->
<button class="btn btn-primary" disabled>Sending...</button>

```

Hierarchy rule

✓ **Good** — one primary, secondary as alternative, ghost for "I changed my mind":

| [Book a shoot] [View portfolio] Cancel

✗ **Bad** — two primaries compete:

| [Book a shoot] [View portfolio]

✗ **Bad** — three secondaries with no hierarchy:

| [Book] [Portfolio] [Contact]

States are deliberately quiet — hover shifts background only. **No drop shadows, no scale transforms, no upward translate. Photojournalist brands don't bounce.**

7. Voice & tone in writing

Always

- **Direct.** Say what happened, not how it felt.
- **Sport-fluent.** Use the actual terminology of each sport ("78th minute", "qualifying session", "lane line", "third period").
- **Athlete-respectful.** The athlete is always the hero, never the photographer.
- **Confident without claiming.** The work and the press credits do the boasting.

Never

- "Capturing moments that last a lifetime."
- "Passionate about my craft."
- Generic adjectives like "stunning," "amazing," "beautiful."
- Photographer-as-hero language.
- Exclamation marks for emphasis.

Examples — Do / Avoid

✓ Do

✗ Avoid

Equaliser, 78th minute. Hibernians 1-1 Floriana.

Capturing the raw emotion of a beautiful moment in Maltese football!

Pitchside coverage, 90 minutes, full gallery in 24 hours.

Passionate sports photography that captures every moment that matters!

✓ Do

✗ Avoid

Featured in the Times of Malta press archive.

Award-winning, internationally recognised photojournalism.

Three sports. Four federations. One season.

Bringing your sports memories to life through the magic of photography.

Tone register

The voice should sit roughly where a sports columnist's voice sits — confident, observational, sport-fluent, with restraint. Not hype-y like a brand promotion, not cold like a corporate spec sheet, not florid like wedding photography copy.

8. Quick reference

Identity

Element	Value
Business name	NF Photography
Personal / credit name	Nicholas Falzon
Tagline	Pitchside, poolside, trackside.
Supporting line	Sport, captured properly.
Values	Craft · Speed · Range · Trust

Element	Value
Personality	A sports photojournalist who takes the work seriously and knows how to get it done
Primary sports	Football, Futsal, Motorsport, Waterpolo
Market	Malta + occasional regional travel
Positioning tier	Mid-tier professional

Visual

Element	Value
Logo	NF monogram with four-corner symmetric frame brackets
Foundation black	 #0A0A0A
Brand teal	 #14B8A6
Brand navy	 #1E3A8A
Heading font	Space Grotesk (variable, 400–700)
Body font	Inter (variable, 400–700)
Type scale	1.25 modular (minor third), base 16px
Border-radius (cards)	8px
Border-radius (buttons)	6px

The complete asset kit

File	Contains
NF-Photography-Brand-Guidelines.pdf	Designed PDF version of this document
NF-Photography-Brand-Brief.md	Detailed brand brief (markdown)
nf-logo-with-frame-a-symmetric.png	Master logo · 520×520 raster
nf-frame-brackets-overlay.svg	Brackets-only · drop onto your vector logo file
nf-color-system.css	Full colour token system · light + dark mode
nf-color-system-docs.md	Colour usage documentation
nf-typography.css	Typography tokens, base styles, fonts
nf-typography-docs.md	Typography usage documentation
nf-buttons.css	Button component spec
nf-buttons-docs.md	Button component documentation

What's intentionally absent from this system

A few deliberate omissions, because constraints make a brand:

- **No blue or purple in the palette.** Teal + navy already cover the cool spectrum. A third cool colour dilutes the editorial feel.
- **No third accent colour beyond teal and navy.** Two is the limit for harmony.

- **No serif body type.** Editorial *headings* in serif can work; editorial *body* in serif feels old-fashioned for a digital-first brand in 2026.
 - **No condensed display fonts** (Bebas Neue etc.) common in sport branding — they feel "marketing" rather than "editorial."
 - **No teal or navy CTA buttons.** Brand colours are for brand moments, not for asking the user to click.
 - **No drop shadows, glows, or scale transforms** anywhere in the system. Quiet motion only. Photojournalist brands don't bounce.
-

Final note

This is a working document. The brand will change as the work changes. When something written here stops being true, update the document — don't keep the work consistent with an outdated rule.

The goal is always the same: **serious sport photojournalism, properly delivered.**